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With the hype built around the UPA Government's 100-day mark, a look at the achievers and the also-rans, the laggards and the losers in the Cabinet

Though Governments in India are elected for a five-year term, the first few months set the tone and provide early hints about the course it plans to take. While it would be unfair to judge a new regime on the basis of its first 100 days in office, there has been some hype built around this mark ever since President Pratibha Patil spelt out the new Government's priorities in her address to the joint session of Parliament on June 4 and ambitious ministers scrambled to announce agendas for their respective departments. On August 29, the UPA Government crossed that first milestone of its second tenure and if the event went mostly unmarked, it was because even ministers who were on a programme inauguration spree quickly realised that implementation is the harder part. There has been progress on some fronts and setbacks on others, leaders setting the pace in some portfolios and laggards struggling to keep up. The Union Council of Ministers includes 78 ministers—33 of Cabinet rank, including the Prime Minister, seven Ministers of State with Independent Charge and 38 Ministers of State—but we focussed on the Prime Minister and his 20 colleagues, who for good or bad always manage to stay in the news. A progress report.